

EVERYDAY TOOLS — TOOL BUILD (INSTRUMENT + ATMOSPHERE)

Tate Break

Atmosphere refinement of the Companion direction — typography, spacing, color, and motion

Tool: Tate Break

Module: Everyday Tools — Summit on Human Dignity

Assignment: Tool Build (instrument + atmosphere)

Direction refined: Companion (chosen in Interface Ritual Sketch)

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Live deployed link (updated): <https://claude.ai/artifact/JBJwbkipTkLsmoyFoY6Ndo>

GitHub repository (updated): <https://github.com/triddell29-lgtm/tate-break-mechanics>

Video reflection: atmosphere-pass-reflection.mp4, 42 seconds — attached separately alongside this PDF

WHAT THIS PASS CHANGED

The previous submission (Tool Build — mechanics) built the trigger-and-companion loop itself: a fixed 10-scroll count, a 15-second breathing hold, an always-visible tally. Mechanics were frozen for this pass on purpose — nothing about *when* or *why* Tate appears changed. This pass only touches *how the breathing moment looks and moves*, working from the Companion direction's own charter language:

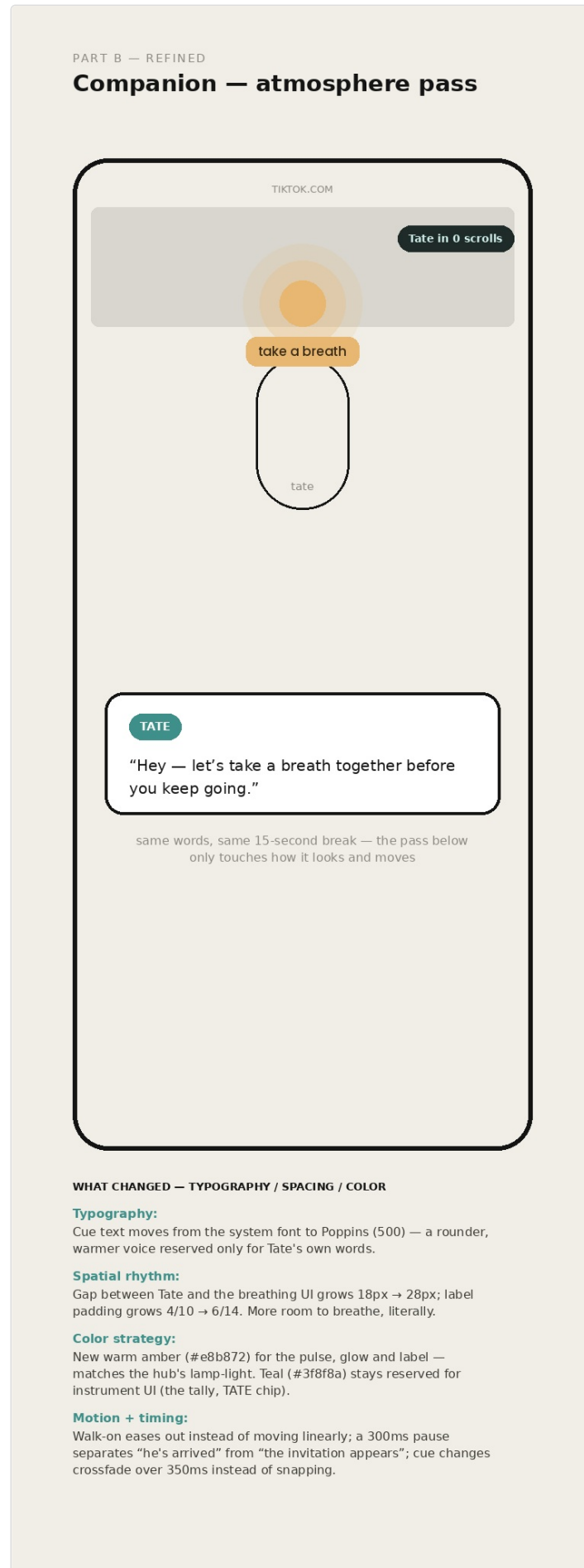
"Warm and domestic, not clinical. A friend stopping by for fifteen seconds, not a system flagging behavior. The hub's 'room' reinforces that tone outside of the break moment too — it's a place, not a dashboard."

— SYSTEM_CHARTER.md, Section 7 (Atmospheric Tone)

Four dimensions were refined, each described in detail below: typography, spatial rhythm, color strategy, and motion + timing. A Dignity Audit at the end confirms none of them touch the one element this tool is not allowed to soften: the exact, disclosed scroll tally.

REFINEMENT PASS — BEFORE/AFTER INTERFACE FRAMES

Before touching code, the Companion direction's existing frame (from the Interface Ritual Sketch submission) was refined as a set of annotated interface frames — rendered mockups in the same wireframe visual language as that submission's direction sketches (cream background, black phone frame, wide-tracked small-caps labels), not literal software exports. The frames below document the typography, spacing, and color decisions before they were implemented in `tateRenderer.js` / `content.js`.



Refined frame — the Companion breathing moment, annotated with the four changes below.

Signature Interaction: the same 5 states, atmosphere applied

1 . IDLE

3 / 10

SCROLLS SO FAR

Small, low-contrast tally in the corner.
Unchanged - the atmosphere pass never touches this.

2 . APPROACHING

9 / 10

SCROLLS SO FAR

Same tally, closer to 10. Still no color change, no alarm.

3 . ARRIVAL

feed dims, video pauses

300ms pause ->

NEW: a 300ms still beat before anything else appears - he settles in first.

4 . BREATHING

Breathe in...

NEW: warm amber pulse + glow, Poppins label, crossfading cues (350ms).

5 . DEPARTURE

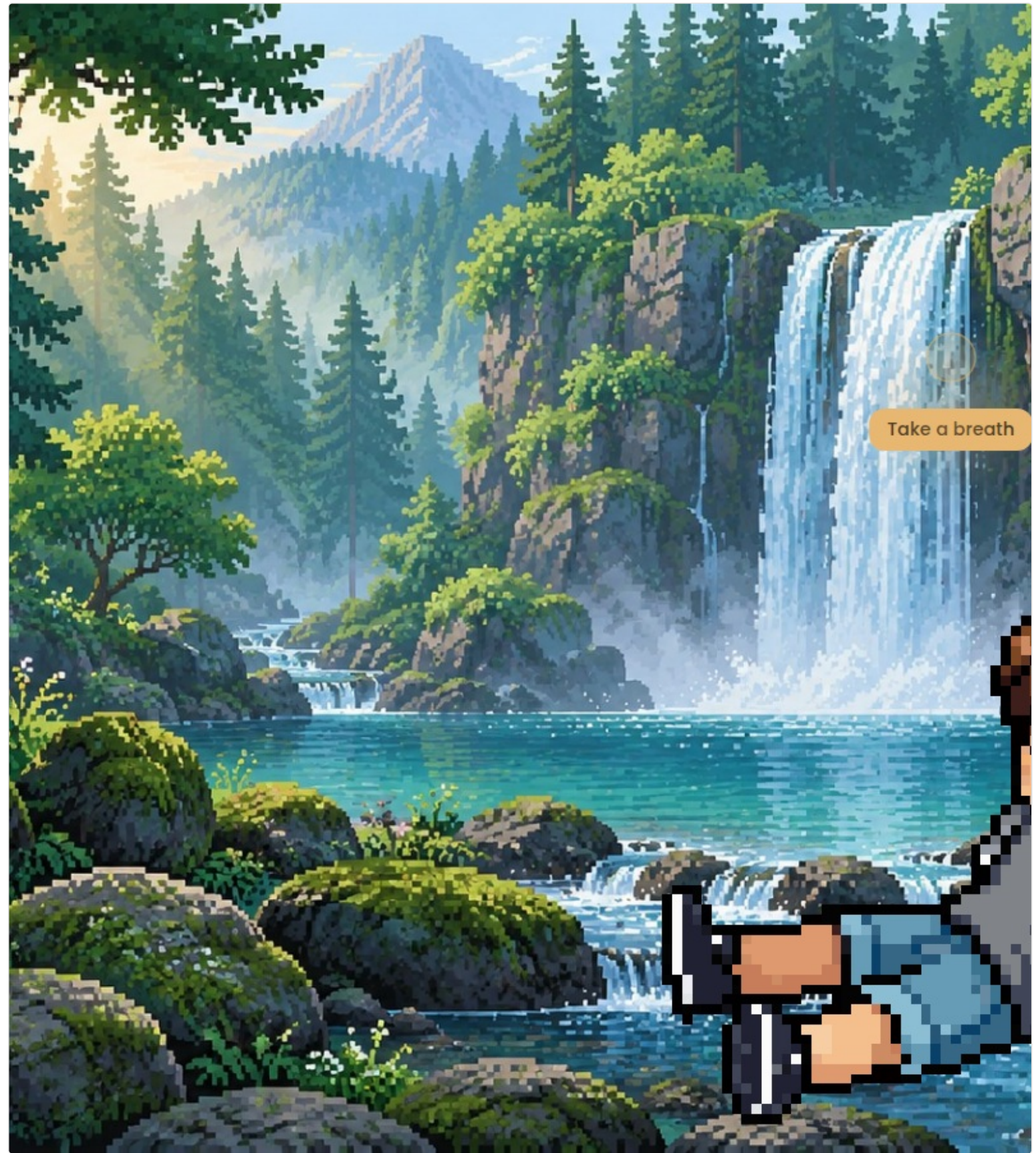
0 / 10

SCROLLS SO FAR

He gets up, walks off - easing in, not the flat linear exit. Tally already back to zero.

^ seam: the number, not a guess -- still the ONLY thing the atmosphere pass leaves completely alone

The same 5-state signature interaction from the original submission, atmosphere applied to states 3-4. States 1, 2, and 5 (the tally) are drawn identically on purpose — they're the states this pass isn't allowed to touch.



The refined frames as actually implemented and running in the mechanics prototype (Playwright screenshot, not a mockup).

TYPOGRAPHY

Before: every string in the tool, instrumental or not, used the same system-ui stack (`-apple-system, BlinkMacSystemFont, 'Segoe UI', system-ui, sans-serif`) at a plain 13px.

After: Tate's own words — the breathing label and cycling cues — move to **Poppins** (weight 500, 14px), a rounder, warmer geometric sans reserved only for his voice. Everything instrumental (the tally pill, the feed, post text) stays on the neutral system-ui stack. The split itself is the point: a companion's words get a different, warmer typeface than the interface reporting a number.

Poppins ships with no network dependency: the two weights actually used were subset to just the glyphs in the tool's own strings (Regular and Medium, ~7KB each after subsetting) and embedded as base64 `data:` URIs inside a single `@font-face` rule — the same inlining pattern the build already used for images, and one that works identically inside the Chrome extension's content-script-injected `<style>` tag, where a live Google Fonts stylesheet request could be blocked by a strict third-party site CSP.

SPATIAL RHYTHM

Element	Before	After
Gap between Tate and the breathing UI	18px	28px
Breathing label padding	4px 10px	6px 14px
Breathing pulse diameter	46px	52px, plus a 140px soft glow behind it

More room around the one moment the tool asks you to slow down for — the spacing itself is meant to read as unhurried, not just the wording.

COLOR STRATEGY

The tool now runs two accents with two different jobs, instead of one accent used everywhere:

■ **Teal (#3f8f8a)** — unchanged, reserved for *instrument* UI: the tally pill, the feed's avatar gradient. Nothing here is allowed to look warmer or friendlier than a plain instrument should — that neutrality is what keeps the tally honest.

■ **Amber (#e8b872, new)** — reserved for *companion presence* UI: the breathing pulse, its glow, and the cue label. Chosen to sit in the same warm family as the hub's own room (its cream panel background and dark-brown border/button in `hub.css` are the same lamp-lit palette), so the 15-second break and the hub feel like one place rather than two different tools.

The rule is deliberately one-directional: warmth was added to the companion moment, and nothing was added to (or taken from) the instrument moment. That asymmetry is the actual design decision, not an oversight.

MOTION + TIMING

What	Before	After
Walk-on	Linear interpolation	Ease-out cubic — Tate arrives and settles, rather than stopping dead
Walk-off	Linear interpolation	Ease-in cubic — he drifts off, rather than snapping into motion
Arrival → invitation	Breathing UI appears the instant lean-down finishes	A new 300ms still beat first — he settles in before the invitation appears
Cue changes	Instant <code>textContent</code> swap every 2s	350ms crossfade (fade out, swap, fade in) — cues feel spoken, not printed
Breathing UI fade-in	0.6s	0.8s

None of these change the break's timing budget: the same fixed 15-second hold is still fully accounted for in `playBreak()`'s sleep math, with the new 300ms pause subtracted from the hold the same way the walk and lean durations already were.

DIGNITY AUDIT

A self-check against the Companion direction's own Dignity and Refusal Clauses, run specifically because this pass touched colors, spacing, and timing — the exact surface area those clauses exist to guard.

PASS — The tally (`#tate-tally`) is visually untouched: same neutral background, same font stack, same exact number. It was not given the new amber accent, and its font-weight was left at 600 rather than being "prettied up."

PASS — No streaks, scores, or shaming colors were introduced. The new amber is warm, not alarming, and is never used to signal "you scrolled too much."

PASS — No new persistence. The atmosphere pass added zero new state; `scrollCount` still resets to zero the instant a break ends, exactly as before.

PASS — The trigger count is still fixed at 10 and still fully disclosed via the tally; nothing about the new arrival pause or crossfade hides or delays that number updating.

PASS — The break still cannot lock the feed permanently or run outside its window: the 300ms pause and 350ms crossfades are subtracted from, not added on top of, the fixed 15-second `breakDurationMs` budget.

WHERE IT'S IMPLEMENTED

Refined identically in both places the Companion breathing moment exists, so the mechanics prototype and the real shipped extension stay visually consistent:

File	Project	What changed
src/output/tateRenderer.js	Mechanics prototype	Easing helpers, arrival pause, cue crossfade, amber/glow/Poppins styling
style.css / build_for_artifact_tool.py	Mechanics prototype	@font-face + color variables (kept in sync across both the live-preview CSS and the Artifact-tool build's duplicated CSS string)
content.js	Real Chrome extension	Same easing/pause/crossfade/amber treatment, same CSP-safe base64 font embedding inside the injected <style> tag

The extension's content.js has no on-page tally at all today (it only logs the count to the console) — that gap predates this pass and is a mechanics question, not an atmosphere one, so it was left alone rather than patched in as a side effect of this assignment.

VIDEO REFLECTION — STORYBOARD

Full video: `atmosphere-pass-reflection.mp4` , 42 seconds (under the 2-minute limit), attached alongside this PDF. No spoken narration — on-screen text throughout, matching the prior submission's format. Both live clips are real Playwright recordings of the actual running prototype (before = the mechanics-only build at commit `71d274b` ; after = this pass), not mockups.

1. **0:00-0:03** — title card: "Instrument + Atmosphere."
2. **0:03-0:16.5** — "BEFORE" label, then a live clip of the breathing moment exactly as shipped in the mechanics submission (white pulse, system font, instant cue swaps).
3. **0:16.5-0:30** — "AFTER" label, then the same moment with the atmosphere pass applied (amber glow, Poppins label, eased arrival).
4. **0:30-0:36 — Reflection, question 1** — on-screen text: "What changed from mechanics to atmosphere?" followed by the typography / color / spacing / motion summary above.
5. **0:36-0:42 — Reflection, question 2** — on-screen text: "How did those changes shift the emotional experience?" followed by: the mechanics version was legible but a little clinical; the arrival pause and crossfading cues make the moment feel spoken-to rather than triggered; the shared amber ties the break to the hub's own room; and the tally was deliberately left exactly as plain as before, because warming up the companion moment while leaving the instrument moment alone was the actual design decision this pass is arguing for.